of the nonconventional weapons division, and myself. The official welcome ceremony of the Israeli defense minister by Secretary of Defense Dick Cheney on the Pentagon parade ground, with the honor guard, the flags, the orchestra, the salute battery firing cannons from the American Civil War—to me it was all like a scene out of a movie. The fate of "spies" is to live in the shadows, entering and exiting from back doors, adopting fictional identities, and so on—and here I found myself suddenly "in the limelight" for the first time. Almost automatically I began looking for a corner where I could see but not be seen.

My next memory of that trip is of a huge conference room adjacent to the office of the secretary of defense at the Pentagon. Sitting on one side of the large table was Secretary of Defense Cheney, surrounded by a dozen three- and four-star generals whose insignia almost blinded us, as well as a few civilians. On the other side of the table, Defense Minister Arens sat opposite Cheney, with the rest of our delegation next to him. The secretary greeted the minister and our delegation, and the minister thanked the secretary for his hospitality and willingness to hear from us, then gave the floor to me. I presented the key points of our information on and assessment of each of Iraq's nonconventional capabilities, as well as our assessment of Saddam Hussein's intentions. Afterwards, Shlomo gave his presentation with phenomenal proficiency—the papers were in front of him, but he did not need them at all. In English with a touch of a Hungarian accent, he performed the "libretto" of his life. All those sitting on the other side of the table were taking notes, and the secretary of defense was listening intently to everything that was being said. I will never forget the moment that Shlomo completed his presentation. Secretary Cheney buried his head in his hands and said, "Good Lord, this is exactly what we need now." He then turned to his men and asked them whether the things we had presented corresponded with what they, the Americans, knew. They responded that they had to check and that they would get back to him with an answer by the end of the day.

During the visit to Washington, briefings were held with Under Secretary of State Larry Eagleburger (Secretary James Baker was abroad), CIA director William Webster, our ambassador, and our military attaché. A professional highlight was our briefing to a joint forum of directors of analysis from the CIA, the DIA (the Defense Intelligence Agency), and the State Department, which was convened specially and was unprecedented in